NYU GSAS Dissertation Formatting Guidelines

What follows is an example of a properly formatted dissertation and associated requirements for each section of the dissertation. Each page provides both an example of a correctly formatted page and any associated requirements.

Below is a summary of formatting requirements that must be followed throughout the entire dissertation, along with special instructions for certain departments.

The following formatting requirements apply to the entirety of the dissertation (including cover page, references, appendices, etc.) for all disciplines:

Paper size: 8.5"x11"

Margins: 1" on all sides

Page numbers: must appear at least .75" from the edge of the page and remain unobscured. Page numbers must be bottom-centered or top-centered. Do not interchange the page number location throughout the dissertation.

Text: at least 10pt legible font, double spaced

Consistency: Choose a consistent naming and formatting scheme for the entire dissertation. (i.e. chapter numbering, figure naming, etc.). Follow a consistent formatting style manual used throughout the dissertation: MLA, Chicago/Turabian or APA.

The following requirements apply for certain departments or circumstances:

IFA and Music students only: Plates and/or Catalogues can be treated in one of two ways:

1. Option 1: As Appendices. When placed in this position, the pages should appear after the conclusion before the Bibliography/References/Works Cited.and will receive page numbers.
2. Option 2: Alternatively, these items may be placed at the end of the manuscript, immediately following the Bibliography/References/Works Cited section. If submitted in this format, the pages do not receive page numbers. However, plates and/or catalogued items must be numbered sequentially; e.g., Plate 1, Plate 2, etc.

International dual PhD students only: The formatted version you submit in ProQuest must meet GSAS formatting requirements, regardless of any other formatting requirements provided by your second university.

For foreign language dissertations: Any and all pages may be in the desired language of the dissertation. Abstract in ProQuest ETD can just be one abstract in desired language

The dissertation example and formatting requirements begin on the next page, starting with the cover page.

Cover page guidelines:

Dissertation title: your dissertation title must match **exactly** on ProQuest, your title page, and on your Oral Defense Form

Author name: **your name must match exactly wherever it appears**: on the title page, on the copyright page, on ProQuest, and on your Oral Defense Form. **IMPORTANT: the name used for your dissertation must match your name as it will appear on your diploma**. If the name you would like to use for the dissertation does not match your legal name (as provided to the registrar at enrollment) in any way, or if you want to use a middle initial etc. you must contact the registrar to ensure your preferred name is updated and will be used on your diploma. Contact GSAS with any questions. By default, your "primary" name (as it is entered in Albert and as it appears on your NYU transcript) is printed on your diploma. You can elect to have your "preferred" name (as it is entered in Albert) printed on your diploma by updating the Diploma Options page in your Student Center before your conferral date.

Graduation date: this is the date that your degree is conferred (either January, May, or August). It is NOT the date you complete your oral defense or manuscript. The copyright year matches the year of graduation on the cover page, regardless of any publication deferral options selected.

Advisor name: Provide a signature line for your dissertation advisor above their typed full name. The line must be a solid black line (_____). If you have two advisors, the signature lines should be stacked on top of each other (this is provided in the following example). See graduation checklist for advisor signature requirements; your final dissertation submission should NOT include the signed version of the cover page.

A Formatting Guide for Successful Completion of the Doctoral Dissertation

by

[Jane Doe]

A dissertation submitted in partial fulfillment

of the requirements for the degree of

Doctor of Philosophy

Department of [----------]

New York University

[Month], [Year]

_____

[Advisor's Name]

_____

[Co-Advisor's Name (if applicable)]

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[A copyright page is optional, but is required if you select a copyright order in ProQuest. Your name matches exactly on this page as it does on the cover page. The year is your year of graduation regardless of any publication deferral options selected.]

[OPTIONAL BLANK PAGE]

[An optional blank page may follow the copyright page. It is not numbered.]

[OPTIONAL FRONTISPIECE]

An optional illustration/image or quote. It appears either after the copyright page or after the optional blank page that follows the copyright page. Quotes or illustration labels can be single-spaced. The frontispiece must adhere to the margin and font size requirements. The page is not numbered and is not included in the table of contents. If using an image, it does not need to be labeled or included in the List of Figures.

DEDICATION

[The Dedication page, if included, will be the first numbered page. (If you do not include a dedication, whichever of the next following pages appears first will be the first numbered page.)

It has a section header that identifies it as the dedication page. Section headers in this sample are all-caps, but that is not required. Leave at least two blank lines between the heading of the abstract, preface, introduction, a chapter, etc., and the first line of text on the page.

The Dedication page and all other front material following will be numbered with a lower case Roman numeral.

This is the first numbered page, but all preceding pages including the title page are counted. For example, this page represents the fifth page in sequence beginning with the title page, therefore it bears the number v. Page numbers must be bottom-centered or top-centered. Do not interchange the page number location throughout the dissertation. Page number locations must be consistent. Every page from this point forward must receive a page number.

This section and all following sections must be listed in the table of contents.]

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

[Provide acknowledgements here. It is identified with a section header, is double spaced, and is included in the Table of Contents. Acknowledgments can be more than one page in length.]

PREFACE

[The Preface, like most other front matter material, is optional. If included it must be identified with a section header, numbered with lower case roman numerals, double spaced, and included in the Table of Contents.]

ABSTRACT

[Also optional. If included, it must match exactly to the abstract provided in the appropriate field of your submission in ProQuest. If included it must be identified with a section header and included in the Table of Contents.

If included in the dissertation, do not include the author's name, dissertation title, advisor's name, or graduation date as part of the abstract.

This is final allowed section of the front matter. There are no other sections allowed, and they must appear in this order.]

TABLE OF CONTENTS

[This begins the list portion of the front matter. **A table of contents is required**. The page numbers appear in the table as they are on the pages themselves (lower case roman numerals for front matter, Arabic numerals for the body of the dissertation). Lists of Figures, List of Tables, List of Plates, List of Abbreviations, List of Illustrations, List of Appendices; a Catalog, a Glossary (if applicable), and the Bibliography must be indicated in the Table of Contents. All lists, including the Table of Contents, must be double-spaced. Subsections within lists should be at least 1.5 spaced (e.g., in chapter subsections listed in the Table of Contents).

A Bibliography/References/Works Cited section must be included as the final section of the dissertation, and must always be listed last in the Table of Contents. *NOTE: IFA and Music students may include Plates or a Catalog immediately following the Bibliography.*

Make certain that the page numbers listed in the Table of Contents correspond to the page numbers in the body/text. Note that the pages of the table of contents are numbered, but the Table itself is not listed as an entry.]

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[If you have more than one image/figure included in your dissertation, you must include a List of Figures. All figures must have a title and be numbered sequentially and uniquely (For example, the first image in Chapter 1 and in Chapter 2 may not each be labeled Figure 1). All figures are listed here with their corresponding page number, including those in the Appendices if applicable.]

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[If you have more than one table included in your dissertation, you must include a List of Tables. All tables must have a title and be numbered sequentially and uniquely (For example, the first table in Chapter 1 and in Chapter 2 may not each be labeled Table 1). All tables are listed here with their corresponding page number, including those in the Appendices if applicable.]

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[If you have more than one Appendix included in your dissertation, you must include a List of Appendices. All appendices must be identified sequentially and uniquely. They may have a title but it is not required. All Appendices are listed here with their corresponding beginning page numbers. The list of appendices is the final list. If you have other lists (maps, schemes, abbreviations, etc.) they should appear prior to the list of appendices.]

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[This concludes the front matter.

All front matter must appear in this order. **There are no other allowed sections in the front matter.**

Below are examples of other kinds of sections you may want to include and where to place them:

→ If including a **Glossary**, the Glossary must precede the Bibliography/References/ Works Cited section at the end of the dissertation.

→ Any **publication notes** should be in the Acknowledgements, an appendix, or included in the relevant chapter as a footnote or introductory text.

→ The same applies to **notes on translation or transliteration**; they should be included in the preface, introduction, in a footnote in relevant sections, or as an appendix.]

INTRODUCTION

The body, or text, of your dissertation begins with the Introduction or Chapter 1 (if there is no Introduction). The first page of this body/text is numbered with Arabic numeral 1. Beginning with this page 1, all subsequent pages are numbered consecutively throughout the end of the dissertation.

Typeface/fonts must be at least 10 pt. or higher for the entire dissertation including footnotes, figure captions, table content, etc. (we request 12 pt. if using Times New Roman). Recommended type styles are Arial, Century Gothic, and Courier. Here is a comparison of size 10 pt. in the different fonts:

*Times New Roman The quick brown fox jumped over the lazy dogs.[1]

*Arial The quick brown fox jumped over the lazy dogs.[2]

Century Gothic The quick brown fox jumped over the lazy dogs.

Courier New The quick brown fox jumped over the lazy dogs.

Leave at least two blank lines between the heading of the abstract, preface, introduction, a chapter, etc., and the first line of text on the page.

Leave at least two blank lines between the last line of text and/or footnote(s) and the page number.

[1] Web font is designed for easy screen readability. Since many readers are likely to view and/or use your dissertation onscreen, you may wish to improve the readability of your text by using one of these fonts.
[2] This is an example of a properly formatted footnote. It must be single spaced and at least 10pt font. There is ample space (at least two lines) between the footnote and the body text and page number so that no text is obscured.

CHAPTER 1: My First Chapter

Note that this chapter page numbering continues from the preceding page. You may choose to include subsections of a chapter. If that is the case, they should be clearly indicated but are not all required to be included on the table of contents. You may choose to number them or not, but ensure formatting and naming consistency regardless of your choice.

Figure 1.1. An image of your research. Please note that the figure title and caption must be at least 10pt spaced. The caption should be single spaced. The figure is numbered sequentially and uniquely. All figures/images/schemes must be labeled. The figure title should match exactly on the page as it appears in the list of figures. Any page that has a figure or image should be numbered.

1.1 Abstract

Within the chapter, you may choose to include a chapter abstract. Chapters can also include notes on translation, publication acknowledgements, and references.

1.2 Tables

Tables, like figures, must appear on numbered pages and receive sequential and unique identifying labels/titles. They can also be single spaced. For example:

Table 1. Example table

NAMES	NUMBERS	CONCLUSIONS
Danny Lu	1310	Strong in latest Education standards
Adam Byrne	1370	Public officials view as contender
Christine Alberts	1440	Does not accept competition
Alex Torres	1110	Did not accept variables as valid

Note that the table does not extend into the margins.

Let's say you have a large figure or table that needs a full page's width to include all data. In that case, you'd orient the page horizontally as on the following page:

This is an example of a landscaped page. Note: Location of page numbers stays consistent throughout the entire dissertation. The page number is positioned so that it will align with other pages (bottom center) when the page is turned for printing and publication.

Table 2. A landscape-oriented table

NAME	Awards	Presentation
Summer Sanchez	Doctoral degree in Psychology; Graduated with honors from Gil University '98	"Children and the Media
Spring Marks	-Slater Award for Outstanding citizenship among students; - Mentor-Mentee Fellowship	"Citizen Marks: The Academic Life of a University Student"
Renata Martin	Hilaire Award for Outstanding Lecture Skills; Doctoral Degree in World Economics	"The World is Not Enough: The United States' Vision of Conquest"
Julie Smith	Ledesma Award for Linear Algebra; Master's Degree in Perfect Geometry	"Math: Linear Algebra as an Abstract Ideal"

Remember to make sure the page number stays unobscured.

1.3 References

You may decide to include references in each chapter rather than at the end of the dissertation. This is permitted. In this case, they must all appear at the end of the chapter (there may not be any chapter information that appears after the references section). If you include references in each chapter, you do not need to provide a full bibliography/reference list at the end of the dissertation.

CONCLUSION

A conclusion section is not required. If included, it should appear after your chapters and before any appendices or references. It has a section header and is included in the table of contents like any other chapter.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX 1: Research Methodology

Let's say you have supplementary information you would like to include in the dissertation but does not fit within the main chapters. In that case, you can include it as an appendix. This can be anything from supplementary figures, notes on translation, or expanded details on research methods or data. The appendix appears after the last chapter or conclusion but before the References/Bibliography. All pages of the appendix are numbered, and it must follow the same formatting rules as the rest of the dissertation:

→ Text must be double spaced

→ Figures and tables must be labeled sequentially and uniquely

→ 1" margin on all sides

If you include just one Appendix, it can appear just as chapters do on the Table of Contents.

If you include more than one Appendix, you must provide a List of Appendices in the front matter where each appendix appears with its title alongside the first page number at which it can be found. Each appendix should be labeled in a consistent and progressive manner.

APPENDIX 2: Supplemental Figures

This Appendix includes supplementary figures. Note they all are titled and appear on the list of figures as with all other figures in the dissertation.

Figure A.1. Supplementary Figure 1

Figure A.2. Supplementary Figure 2

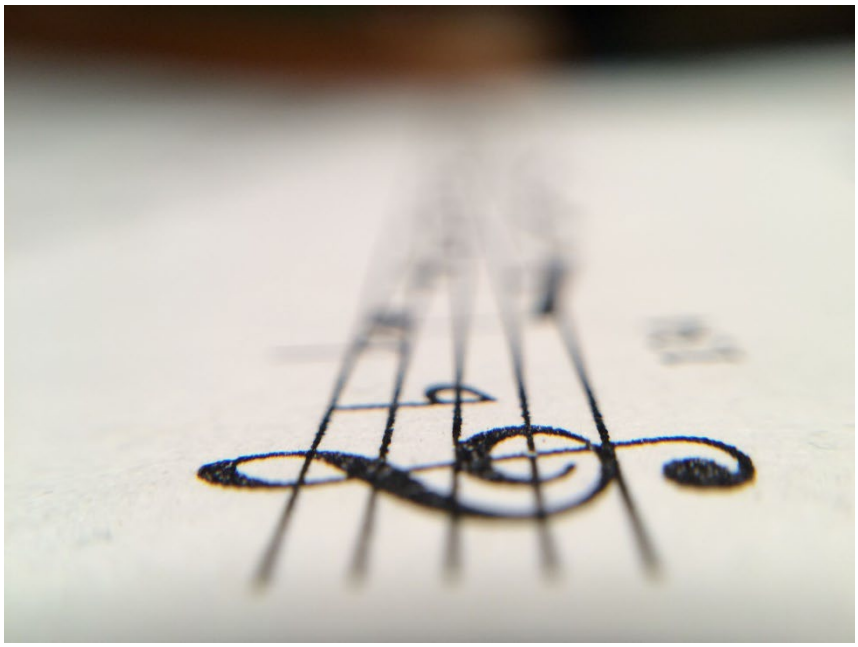

Figure A.3. Supplementary Figure 3

REFERENCES

[This section can be called REFERENCES, BIBLIOGRAPHY, or WORKS CITED.

The list must be double spaced as with the rest of the dissertation. Individual citations may be 1.5 spaced. The references section is the very last section of the dissertation. No information may follow it. The page numbering continues from the rest of the dissertation. Follow the same reference style guide as used throughout the dissertation/is appropriate for your discipline.]

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